Aromatic spicing balances the natural sweetness of the parsnips in this warming soup. Beef stock will give the best flavor, but chicken or vegetable stock can also be used.

curried parsnip soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 25 MINS **COOK** 30 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
BEFORE CREAM IS ADDED

1 heaped tbsp coriander seeds
1 tsp cumin seeds
1 dried red chile or ½ tsp crushed hot red pepper flakes
1 rounded tsp ground turmeric
¼ tsp ground fenugreek
1 medium onion, chopped
1 large garlic clove, split in half
1½lb (675g) parsnips, cored and diced
2 tbsp butter
1 tbsp flour
1 quart (1 liter) vegetable stock, beef stock, or chicken stock
salt and freshly ground black pepper
⅔ cup heavy cream
chopped chives or parsley, to garnish

1 Process the first five ingredients in a coffee grinder, or pound the whole spices in a mortar, then mix with the ground. Transfer the mixture to a small jar—you will not need all of it for this recipe.

2 Cook the onion, garlic, and parsnips gently in the butter, lid on the pan, for 10 minutes. Stir in the flour and 1–2 tbsp of the spice mixture. Cook for 2 minutes, stirring from time to time. Pour in the stock gradually, stirring constantly. Bring to a boil and let simmer gently for 10–15 minutes or until the parsnips are really tender.

3 Purée until smooth in a blender, then dilute to taste with water. Season to taste with salt and freshly ground black pepper, then reheat. Add the cream and serve with the chives or parsley scattered over the top.



PARSNIPS
Widely produced organically, parsnips should be heavy for their size, with firm, unblemished skin. To prepare, trim the ends, then peel thinly. Baby parsnips can be cooked whole, while larger ones should be sliced and diced.